

Local Server Setup Guide

A Comprehensive Manual for XAMPP & WordPress

1. Installing XAMPP

XAMPP provides the environment needed to run PHP and MySQL on your local machine.

Step A: Download

Navigate to **apachefriends.org**. Download the version corresponding to your Operating System (Windows, Linux, or macOS). Use the most recent PHP version for better security and performance.

Step B: Installation

- Launch the installer. On Windows, click "OK" on any UAC warnings.
- The default directory `C:\xampp` is recommended to avoid permission issues.
- Ensure **Apache** and **MySQL** are selected in the components list.

Step C: Activation

Open the **XAMPP Control Panel** and click "Start" for both Apache and MySQL. Once the names turn green, visit `http://localhost` to confirm.

2. Installing WordPress

With the server running, you can now deploy WordPress locally.

Step A: File Acquisition

Download the WordPress core zip file from **wordpress.org/download** and extract the contents.

Step B: Local Deployment

- Locate your `htdocs` folder inside the XAMPP directory.
- Move the extracted wordpress folder into `htdocs`.
- You may rename the folder to reflect your site's name (e.g., "my_site").

Step C: Database & Install

Access **phpMyAdmin** via `localhost/phpmyadmin` and create a new database. Then, navigate to `localhost/your-folder-name` in your browser.

Standard XAMPP Database Credentials:

- **Username:** root
- **Password:** (Keep this field empty)
- **Database Host:** localhost